WHERE TO FIND REAL INTERNSHIPS

70+ genuine portals, programs and hidden routes
for tech and non-tech students

The Internship Discovery Playbook • 2026-27

Created for the Saumya Singh community

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Links and portal status checked on 15 September 2026. Openings change daily, so always verify the role on the employer or organiser's official page.

Start here: the four-bucket system

Do not depend on only one app. A strong internship search uses four different channels at the same time.

Bucket	What it includes	Weekly action
1. Structured programs	Government schemes, corporate early-career pages, research fellowships and formal cohorts.	Check fixed windows and prepare documents before the deadline.
2. Internship and job platforms	Large job boards, startup boards, remote platforms and niche portals.	Create precise alerts and apply to fresh, relevant listings.
3. Hidden opportunities	Startups, professors, creators, agencies, NGOs, alumni and local businesses.	Send five researched messages with one relevant proof link.
4. Self-created opportunities	A short project you propose after identifying a real problem.	Pitch a small, measurable 2-6 week outcome.

A portal is a discovery tool, not a guarantee

- Never pay for selection, an offer letter, a security deposit or a guaranteed certificate.
- Prefer roles posted recently and verify them on the organisation’s official domain.
- Check eligibility, location, working hours, stipend terms and college approval before applying.

Bucket 1: Government and public programs

Best for students interested in public policy, data, engineering, law, science, development, finance, media and administration.

#	Portal / program	Best for	How to use it
1	AICTE National Internship Portal	Tech + non-tech students	National portal connecting students with companies, startups, MSMEs and public organisations. Applications should be free.
2	Skill India Digital Internship	Students and freshers	Browse free and paid internships linked to skilling pathways.
3	National Career Service	All domains	Government career portal. Search “intern” and verify employer details.
4	PM Internship Scheme	Eligible youth under the scheme	Check current eligibility, partner companies, duration and application cycle.
5	NITI Aayog Internship	Policy, economics, data, engineering, social sciences	Official application window is the 1st-10th of every month; follow lead-time rules.
6	DPIIT Internship Scheme	Business, law, economics, engineering and policy	Official recurring windows are listed on MyScheme.
7	MEA Internship Portal	International relations, policy and eligible graduates	Monitor term announcements and read age/education rules.
8	MoSPI NIOS Internship	Statistics, mathematics, economics and data	Phase-based government statistics internships.
9	NHRC Internship Programmes	Law, human rights and social sciences	Online plus summer/winter in-person programs.
10	ISRO Internship and Projects	Science and engineering UG/PG/PhD	Read central rules, then check the relevant ISRO centre.
11	DRDO Internship Search	Engineering and science	Search official lab-specific paid and unpaid notices.
12	NHAI Internship Portal	Engineering, AI/data, law, HR, finance, marketing and media	Formal winter and term programs; institute approval may be required.
13	RBI Research Internship	Economics, finance, statistics and research	Use only RBI Opportunities for current instructions.
14	SEBI Legal Internship	Law students	Check the official legal internship portal and current notices.
15	Digital India / MeitY	Technology, policy and digital governance	Watch the official scheme page for cycles and disciplines.
16	FSSAI Internship	Food science, law, management, communications and tech	Batch notices are published on the official FSSAI page.
17	Competition Commission of India	Law, economics, finance and management	Read monthly/periodic guidelines and submission rules.
18	Ministry of Environment	Environment, forestry, policy, law and science	Check the current scheme and eligible subject list.

Bucket 1B: Research and university programs

Use formal programs, but also check department pages and faculty profiles. Many research internships never appear on regular job boards.

#	Program / portal	Best for	Important note
1	IIT Bombay Research Internship	Engineering and research	Check current project calls and eligibility.
2	IIT Gandhinagar SRIP	UG research	Annual summer research program.
3	IIT Hyderabad SURE	UG research	Watch the official research announcements.
4	IIT Madras Young Research Fellow	Research-focused graduates	Check current YRF projects and criteria.
5	IIT Ropar Summer Internship	UG/PG research	Department and annual program updates.
6	TIFR VSRP	Physics, chemistry, biology, math and CS	Highly selective visiting student research program.
7	Science Academies SRFP	Science and research students	Annual fellowship with scientist mentorship.
8	JNCASR SRFP	Science and engineering	Check current fellowship cycle.
9	IISER Pune Summer Student Programme	Science research	Annual institute program; verify dates.
10	IIIT Hyderabad Research Portal	CS, AI, data, language and robotics	Explore labs and contact relevant faculty with proof.
11	Mitacs Globalink	International research	Check country, year and university eligibility.
12	DAAD WISE	Indian science/engineering students	Germany research scholarship; verify annual call.
13	Campus France Charpak	Study/research exposure in France	Select the correct Charpak program and cycle.
14	CERN Students	Physics, engineering, computing and administration	Multiple student programs; nationality rules differ.
15	KAUST VSRP	STEM research	International visiting student research projects.
16	CS Research Programs List	Computer science research discovery	Community list only; verify every opportunity officially.

Bucket 2: India internship and job platforms

Use filters for internship, fresher, remote/hybrid, location, skill and date posted. Never apply to every listing with the same resume.

#	Platform	Best for	Smart search
1	Internshala	Indian students; tech + non-tech	Filter stipend, work-from-home and part-time; verify employer.
2	LinkedIn Jobs	All professional roles	Use Boolean keywords and “Past 24 hours”; follow employees.
3	Naukri	Indian corporate roles	Create role-specific alerts and keep profile complete.
4	Indeed India	Broad local and corporate search	Search exact role + intern + city/remote.
5	Foundit India	Freshers and corporate roles	Use profile and skill filters.
6	Unstop Internships	Students, campus roles and competitions	Useful for internships plus challenges and hiring contests.
7	Freshersworld	Freshers and entry-level roles	Verify company and never pay an agent.
8	Glassdoor India	Jobs plus company reviews	Use reviews for research, not as final proof.
9	Shine	Indian job listings	Use narrow role and location keywords.
10	TimesJobs	Corporate and entry-level	Sort by freshness and verify employer site.
11	Hirist	Technology roles	Search junior/intern roles in software, data and product.
12	iimjobs	Business, finance, consulting, HR and marketing	Search internships and early-career roles; many listings prefer experience.

Bucket 2B: Startup and product opportunities

Startups often hire faster and care strongly about proof of work. Read the product, team size, funding stage and role scope before messaging.

#	Platform	Best for	How to use it
1	Wellfound India	Startup roles across functions	Filter internship, remote, location and company stage.
2	Y Combinator Jobs	High-growth startups globally	Search internships and confirm country/work authorization.
3	Cutshort	Indian tech and startup roles	Create a skills-first profile and targeted alerts.
4	Instahyre	Curated tech/product hiring	Best after building a credible profile and projects.
5	Hirect	Direct startup recruiter conversations	Keep messages specific and verify company identity.
6	Startup India	Discover recognised Indian startups	Use startup directory for company research and direct outreach.
7	F6S Jobs	Global startups and accelerator companies	Check remote eligibility and compensation.
8	Product Hunt	Discover newly launched startups	Not primarily a job board. Find products, then visit company careers/contact.
9	Inc42 Startup Database	Indian startup discovery	Use for research; apply through official company channels.
10	YourStory Startup Directory	Indian startup discovery	Build a target list, then approach with a useful mini-audit.

Bucket 2C: Remote and global platforms

Remote does not automatically mean “open worldwide.” Always check country eligibility, timezone, work authorization and payment method.

#	Platform	Best for	Caution / use
1	Remote OK	Remote tech/startup roles	Check worldwide tag and employer page.
2	We Work Remotely	Remote tech, design, marketing and support	Search junior/intern; many roles require experience.
3	Remotive	Remote tech and business roles	Use category and location filters.
4	Working Nomads	Curated remote jobs	Search internship/junior and confirm eligibility.
5	Jobspresso	Remote tech, product, marketing and support	Open the original employer listing.
6	Himalayas	Remote roles with company profiles	Filter junior roles and time zones.
7	FlexJobs	Screened remote listings	Paid subscription may be required; evaluate value first.
8	Idealist	NGO, social impact and nonprofit internships	Check country, remote status and unpaid-role expectations.
9	UN Careers	United Nations internships	Eligibility and duty station rules vary.
10	UNICEF Careers	Development, communications, policy, research and tech	Use internship category and official portal only.
11	UN Volunteers	Volunteer assignments and experience	Volunteer role, not automatically an internship or paid job.
12	DevNetJobs India	NGO, development and policy roles	Check employer and compensation independently.

Bucket 2D: Open source and virtual experience

These can become strong experience proof, especially when you ship visible work and can explain your contribution.

#	Program	Best for	What makes it useful
1	Google Summer of Code	Open-source contributors 18+	Paid mentorship program; contributor proposals require preparation.
2	Outreachy	Underrepresented people in tech	Paid remote open-source internships; eligibility rules matter.
3	LFX Mentorship	Linux, cloud, security and open source	Project-specific terms and schedules.
4	MLH Fellowship	Software and open-source experience	Remote internship alternative; verify country and cohort eligibility.
5	Forage	Virtual job simulations across domains	Self-paced experience, not employment. Use it to build understanding.
6	GitHub Student Developer Pack	Students building technical projects	Tools and resources, not an internship portal.
7	CNCF Mentoring	Cloud-native open source	Find project-specific mentorship programs.
8	Season of KDE	Open-source software contributors	Mentored KDE projects; follow current timeline.
9	Summer of Bitcoin	Bitcoin and open-source developers/designers	Check current tracks, stipend and eligibility.
10	Open Mainframe Project Mentorship	Enterprise/open-source tech	Project and term-specific applications.

Bucket 2E: Non-tech and creative portals

For design, writing, marketing, media, education, policy and social impact, a focused portfolio usually matters more than coding credentials.

#	Platform	Best for	Practical use
1	Behance Jobs	Graphic, UI/UX, illustration and creative	Publish 2-3 focused case studies before applying.
2	Dribbble Jobs	UI/UX and visual design	Check location and experience requirements.
3	Internshala	Marketing, HR, writing, design, finance, operations and teaching	Use category filters and assess the work scope.
4	Media India Group Internships	Media, journalism and content	Check current openings and language/location.
5	The Better India Careers	Content, media and social impact	Monitor official career roles and internships.
6	Teach For India Careers	Education and social impact	Check internships, fellowships and staff roles separately.
7	WWF India Careers	Environment, communications and conservation	Monitor internships/volunteering on official site.
8	PRS Legislative Research	Public policy and legislative research	Structured research internship; follow application instructions.
9	Centre for Civil Society	Policy, research and communications	Check current program design and deadlines.
10	Sports Authority of India	Sports management, communications and administration	Monitor official opportunities; do not rely on forwarded PDFs.

Bucket 3: Find hidden opportunities

A hidden opportunity is a real need that has not been posted publicly. Your job is to find the right person and make a relevant, low-friction approach.

Route	How to find people	What to offer
Startups	Startup India, Wellfound, YC directory, accelerator cohorts and funding news.	Product audit, landing-page improvement, dashboard, automation, research or content plan.
Professors and labs	University department pages, Google Scholar and lab websites.	Literature summary, data cleaning, prototype, experiment support or documentation.
Creators and agencies	YouTube About, Instagram bio, LinkedIn company page and agency portfolio.	Editing sample, thumbnail audit, research sheet, content calendar or analytics report.
Alumni and seniors	LinkedIn Alumni search, college alumni cell and student communities.	Ask for role insight and feedback first. Earn a referral through relevance.
NGOs and local businesses	Google Maps, NGO directories, LinkedIn and local networks.	Website, design, social-media plan, Excel system, data dashboard or volunteer project.

The 20-company hidden-market sprint

- Choose one role and one city/industry.
- Build a list of 20 small organisations where your skill is useful.
- Find one real improvement for each organisation.
- Send five personalised messages per week, each with one proof link.
- Follow up once after 5-7 working days. Do not spam.

Bucket 4: Create your own internship

Do not ask an organisation to invent a full internship for you. Offer a small, measurable pilot project that is easy to approve.

Step	Question	Example
1. Observe	What visible problem can I understand without private data?	Slow website, weak social content, manual spreadsheet, confusing onboarding.
2. Diagnose	Can I show evidence in one page?	Three screenshots, quick competitor comparison or small data sample.
3. Propose	What can I complete in 2-4 weeks?	Landing-page prototype, dashboard, 12-post content plan, automation proof-of-concept.
4. Define	What outcome and boundaries are clear?	Deliverables, duration, hours, mentor, access needed and review date.
5. Convert	What will make this credible experience?	Written agreement, feedback, testimonial/certificate and permission to show work.

Self-created internship proposal checklist

Include	Details
Relevant introduction	Course/year, target skill and availability.
Specific observation	One genuine problem or improvement identified after research.
Proof link	A short audit, sample, project or case study.
Defined pilot	A realistic 2-4 week outcome with clear deliverables.
Simple next step	A short discussion to assess fit and scope.

Before accepting

- Ask for a named mentor and written scope.
- Confirm whether the role is paid, unpaid or volunteer before starting.
- Never share confidential work publicly without written permission.
- Agree on a completion letter, testimonial or reference only after satisfactory work.

Search formulas that save time

Goal	Search formula
Fresh roles	"data analyst intern" India AND posted:past week
Six-month roles	"6 month internship" Bengaluru OR Hyderabad OR Pune
Remote non-tech	"content marketing intern" remote India
Startup direct	site:wellfound.com/jobs intern India [skill]
Professor/lab	site:ac.in [topic] lab faculty internship
Government	site:gov.in internship [field] 2026
Company careers	site:companydomain.com/careers intern India
LinkedIn people	[company] [team] recruiter OR engineer OR designer
Creator/agency	[niche] agency India careers OR internship
NGO/policy	internship policy research India site:org

The 10-5-2 weekly system

10 targeted applications	5 personalised messages	2 conversations
Match the core skills, eligibility and availability.	Show one observation and one relevant proof link.	Speak with alumni, seniors, faculty or community members.

Application tracker and quality check

Company	Role	Portal	Applied	Follow-up	Status

P-A-I-D quality check

P - Payment	A - Authenticity	I - Internship work	D - Documentation
No payment for selection, offer letter or “guaranteed” certificate.	Verify official domain, employees, product, address and work history.	Clear responsibilities, mentor, hours, learning and output.	Written offer, duration, stipend terms, reporting details and completion proof.

Score an opportunity out of 10

Criterion	Score
Role matches your target skill	0-2
Real work with measurable output	0-2
Credible organisation and mentor	0-2
Fair stipend or valuable learning with manageable cost	0-2
Written scope, feedback and completion proof	0-2

Below 6/10: investigate carefully. A famous company name does not fix a vague or exploitative role.

Final action plan

Day	Action
1	Choose one internship role and write your three required skills.
2	Make a one-page resume and one strong proof link.
3	Create alerts on five relevant portals from this guide.
4	Build a list of 20 startups, labs, creators, NGOs or businesses.
5	Apply to five fresh roles with a tailored resume.
6	Send three personalised hidden-opportunity messages.
7	Practise your introduction and one project explanation.

Keep learning with Saumya Singh

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YouTube: Saumya Singh
Instagram: @saumya1singh
LinkedIn: Saumya Singh

Verification and responsible use

This directory contains 70+ destinations across official programs, job boards, research programs, remote platforms and opportunity-discovery resources. A listing platform may contain third-party posts, so inclusion does not mean every listing is verified or recommended.

What was verified

• Official government and public-program links were prioritised.

• The AICTE portal identifies itself as the national internship platform and states that applying, shortlisting and certificates cost students zero.

• NITI Aayog states that applications are accepted from the 1st to the 10th of every month.

• ISRO publishes central eligibility for its internship and student project trainee schemes.

• Research, open-source and global programs link to their official home pages where available.

What still changes

• Live vacancies, dates, stipends, eligibility, country access and application forms.

• Third-party job listings and community-maintained repositories.

• Whether a company accepts unsolicited internship proposals.

Last checked: 15 September 2026

Educational resource only. No portal or program is affiliated with or endorsed by Saumya Singh unless explicitly stated. Always verify before submitting documents or accepting an offer.